



NATIONAL YOUTH STATEMENT

臺灣青年氣候宣言



United Nations
Framework Convention on
Climate Change

officially endorsed by



a project of **YOUNGO**
OFFICIAL YOUTH CONSTITUENCY OF THE UNFCCC



Local Conference of Youth
聯合國在地青年氣候論壇



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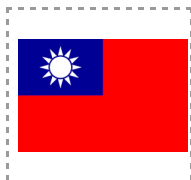


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Taiwan

Local Conference of Youth | <Taiwan>, <2026 May-Oct>

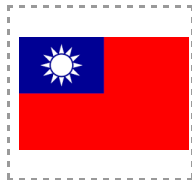
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Taiwan faces climate risks, including extreme weather, air pollution, and biodiversity loss. These priorities, created by young people and children from Taiwan, aim to inspire and nurture further action toward sustainable development across the country.

Top 5 Youth Priorities

- 1 Clean Air, Energy & Sustainable Transportation**
We urge Parties to establish Low Emission Zones (LEZs) in major commercial areas and school districts to reduce air pollution and protect public health. We urge Parties to support low-emission vehicles through financial assistance and use collected fees to improve public transportation and pedestrian safety.
- 2 Climate-Resilient Food & Agriculture**
We urge Parties to reduce excessive dependence on long-distance food trade that can weaken local markets and support policies that prioritize resilient, sustainable, and community-centered agriculture.
- 3 Biodiversity & Ecosystem Conservation**
We urge Parties to turn unused school green spaces into habitats for native species through native plants and eco-ponds; also partner with schools to involve students in wildlife conservation and roadkill prevention.
- 4 Gender Equality & Social Inclusion**
We urge Parties to provide regular gender equality and diversity training in schools, universities, and workplaces. The solution can help address the gender gap.
- 5 Climate Resilience & Disaster Risk Reduction**
We urge Parties to strengthen public education on extreme weather and disaster preparedness. Schools and local governments should provide workshops, online resources, and public campaigns to teach communities how to respond to disasters and reduce climate risks.

We call for a collective voice among Taiwan's young people to take meaningful action on climate change. With strong government and institutional support, we urge Taiwan to advance youth-led climate action and build a more sustainable future.



臺灣 Taiwan

Local Conference of Youth | <Taiwan>, <2026 May-Oct>

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台灣正面臨多項氣候與環境風險，包括極端氣候、空氣污染及生物多樣性流失。這些由台灣青年與兒童共同提出的行動優先事項，旨在凝聚更多關注與行動，進一步推動全國永續發展。

青年五大優先事項 Top 5 Youth Priorities

- 1 潔淨空氣、能源與永續交通**
我們呼籲各方在主要商業區及學校周邊設置「低排放區」(Low Emission Zones, LEZs)，以降低空氣污染並保障公共健康。我們呼籲各方透過提供財務補助等方式，鼓勵低排放車輛的使用，並將所收取的相關費用投入公共運輸及行人安全設施的改善。
- 2 氣候韌性糧食與農業**
我們呼籲各方降低對長距離糧食貿易的過度依賴，以避免削弱在地市場，並推動相關政策，優先支持具氣候韌性、永續且以社區為核心的農業發展。
- 3 生物多樣性與生態系保育**
我們呼籲各方善用校園內閒置的綠地空間，透過種植原生植物、設置生態池等方式，打造適合原生物種棲息的生態環境；同時與學校合作，讓學生參與野生動物保育及道路路殺防治等行動，培養學生對生物多樣性與生態保育的認識與實踐能力。
- 4 性別平等與社會共融**
我們呼籲各方在學校、大專院校及職場定期推動性別平等與多元共融教育，透過持續的培訓與宣導，提升社會對性別平等及多元議題的認識，縮小性別落差。
- 5 氣候韌性與災害風險降低**
我們呼籲各方加強極端氣候與防災準備的公共教育。學校與地方政府應提供工作坊、線上學習資源及公共宣導活動，協助社區建立面對災害的應變能力，降低氣候變遷所帶來的風險。

我們呼籲台灣青年凝聚共同的聲音，針對氣候變遷採取具體且有意義的行動。在政府與各界機構的積極支持下，我們敦促台灣進一步推動由青年主導的氣候行動，共同打造更加永續的未來。

Urbanization, Urban Air Quality & Transport Emissions

PM2.5	Tiny particles in the air that are 2.5 micrometers or smaller. These small particles can enter the lungs and cause health problems.
public health	It is the science of protecting and improving the health of entire communities through education, safety policies, and disease prevention.
transportation method	Transportation methods refer to the means by which people travel from one place to another, such as walking, cycling, public transportation, and private vehicles. Each transportation method has a different environmental impact, particularly in terms of greenhouse gas emissions, energy consumption, and air pollution. Promoting low-carbon transportation can help reduce emissions and improve air quality.
Air pollutant	Air pollution refers to any substance in the atmosphere that is present in concentrations high enough to directly or indirectly endanger public health or the living environment. These pollutants are commonly emitted from motor vehicles, industrial facilities, power plants, construction activities, and agricultural practices. They can contribute to respiratory and cardiovascular diseases, environmental degradation, reduced air quality, and climate change.

Preamble

Urban air quality has become an increasingly important issue in Taiwan as growing transportation demands continue to increase vehicle emissions in densely populated communities. Daily use of fuel-powered motorcycles, cars, and diesel buses contributes significantly to air pollutants such as PM2.5, which can negatively affect residents' respiratory health and overall public well-being. Although Taiwan has introduced policies related to vehicle inspections, net-zero emissions, and the transition to electric public transportation, challenges remain in ensuring effective implementation and equal access across different regions. Therefore, improving transportation systems and reducing emission sources are essential steps toward creating cleaner, healthier, and more sustainable communities.

Research and Current Action

1 Policies for vehicle exhaust treatment systems:

1. Previous Policies

- Under the previous vehicle inspection policy, paper postcard reminders were used to notify vehicle owners when their mandatory vehicle emissions inspections were due.

However, this system generated millions of returned or undelivered notices each year, resulting in significant administrative costs and paper waste. Furthermore, all vehicles were subject to the same inspection frequency regardless of their age or emission levels, leading to an inefficient allocation of inspection resources and limiting the policy's effectiveness in improving air quality and protecting public health.

2. Turning Points

- A new inspection framework was introduced to better allocate resources based on vehicle conditions. Under this system, gasoline passenger cars older than 8 years are required to conduct inspections every two years. At the same time, the government moved from paper postcard reminders into digital communication through the official LINE accounts and SMS notifications.

3. Target Audience

- The regulations target all fuel-powered vehicle owners in Taiwan (motorcycles >5 years, cars >8 years). Frontline operators include authorized private repair shops and inspection stations, while the ultimate beneficiaries are urban residents and commuters who gain from reduced tailpipe emissions.

4. Good Points & Actions

- The government maintains a "0 NTD inspection fee" subsidized by the Air Pollution Control Fund alongside smart SMS reminders. Failed vehicles receive a 30-day repair grace period for a free re-test; continuous non-compliance triggers tiered fines (500–3,000 NTD) or license plate revocation.

5. Gaps & Areas to Be Addressed

- Rural areas may have fewer certified inspection stations, which creates less convenient access for residents. Elders may also experience difficulties with digital notification systems, so the effectiveness of SMS reminders becomes lowered. In addition, current inspections may not detect vehicles that have been illegally modified to pass emission tests while continuing to produce higher levels of pollution during normal use.

2 Policies for net-zero emissions by 2050:

1. Previous Policies

- In the past, Taiwan's climate policy under the older Greenhouse Gas Reduction and Management Act merely aimed for a 50% reduction of 2005 emission levels by 2050. This conservative approach lacked alignment with the international standard of absolute net-zero emissions, creating a policy blind spot where high-emitting industries could plan for partial reduction rather than fundamental structural transformation.
- Previously, Taiwan's climate policies focused mainly on meeting basic requirements without a domestic carbon pricing system. Without financial incentives or costs for carbon emissions, companies had less motivation to invest in renewable energy and reduce their carbon footprint. As a result, emission reduction efforts were often limited and lacked strong market support.

2. Turning Points

- The government introduced the "12 Key Strategies" to accelerate Taiwan's transition toward net-zero emissions. These strategies focus on four major transitions—Energy,

Industry, Lifestyle, and Society—and include expanding solar and wind power, promoting electric vehicles (EVs), deploying Carbon Capture, Utilization, and Storage (CCUS), and introducing carbon fees. At the same time, local governments have begun enacting their own Net-Zero Ordinances. For example, Taipei, New Taipei, and Taichung have set a more ambitious target of reducing carbon emissions by 65% by 2040.

3. Target Audience

- High-Emission Industries

Steel, petrochemicals, semiconductor manufacturing, and electronics supply chains that must comply with international green supply chains (RE100) and pay domestic carbon fees. 【

RE100: A global corporate initiative led by The Climate Group and CDP, encouraging companies to commit to sourcing 100% renewable electricity for their operations by 2050 (or earlier). It has become an important requirement for many international supply chains. 】

- The Public

Everyday commuters and citizens facing lifestyle changes (e.g., the transition to electric scooters/cars and using green transit systems like TPASS).

4. Good Points & Actions

- Economic Incentives

The integration of public infrastructure with direct citizen financial rewards (such as the TPASS 2.0 Frequent Rider Rewards giving up to 30% cashback) effectively drives public behavioral changes toward a "Green Lifestyle."

- Granular Local Goals

The fact that major cities (like Taichung and Taipei) are legally committing to intermediate targets (65% reduction by 2040) shows strong local governmental accountability

5. Gaps & Areas to Be Addressed

- Low Corporate Commitment

Reports show that a large majority of listed companies in Taiwan have still not explicitly set clear, actionable reduction pathways toward the 2050 net-zero targets.

- Energy Structure Disparities

The share of renewable energy varies heavily by region (e.g., Tainan leads due to geography, while Taipei struggles under 1% due to high-density space constraints). The overall power grid still relies heavily on fossil fuels.

3 Widespread adoption of electric buses

- Previous Policies

Public transit used to rely completely on highly polluting diesel buses.

- Turning Points

2050 Net-Zero Roadmap officially banned all subsidies for new diesel buses.

- Target Audience

Daily city commuters, domestic electric vehicle manufacturers, and urban bus operators.

- Good Points & Actions

The government offers financial packages up to NT\$6.8 million per bus. To maximize this impact, the government will implement a phased replacement schedule prioritizing high-density commuter routes. Furthermore, the government will establish a "mileage-based bonus" system that grants additional operational subsidies to transit companies with the

highest daily E-bus mileage, ensuring these vehicles are actively on the road serving commuters rather than sitting idle.

- Gaps & Areas to Be Addressed:

High cost of building charging depots & Grid capacity constraints: We will address this by co-funding the installation of onsite Energy Storage Systems (ESS) at major bus terminals and implementing overnight smart-charging management. This allows the fleet to charge during off-peak hours when the local electrical grid has excess capacity, minimizing infrastructure strain and lowering electricity costs for operators.

Bottleneck in domestic factory production: The government will establish regulatory "green lanes" for certified domestic manufacturers to streamline safety inspections and component import clearances. Additionally, we will offer targeted industrial automation grants to help local factories scale up their assembly lines and stabilize the domestic supply chain.

Policy Recommendation

1. Establishing "Low Emission Zones" (Short-term):

To substantially mitigate urban air pollution and protect public health, we seek the administration to establish Low Emission Zones (LEZs) across major commercial corridors and sensitive school districts. Execution of this initiative will rely on the deployment of Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR) technology at zone perimeters to cross-reference entering vehicles with national emission registries. Vehicles falling below established environmental standards will be subject to a daily regulatory fee, while designated school zones will implement targeted vehicular restrictions during peak student arrival and departure hours. To ensure economic equity, this regulatory framework will be accompanied by targeted financial subsidies to assist small businesses and lower-income residents in transitioning to low-emission vehicles, with all collected revenues legally restricted to reinvestment into regional public transit infrastructure and pedestrian safety initiatives. The implementation of LEZs is expected to significantly reduce transport-related emissions, particularly PM_{2.5}, in densely populated urban areas. By improving urban air quality and lowering public exposure to harmful air pollutants, the policy will contribute to better respiratory health, fewer pollution-related illnesses, and a more sustainable urban transportation system.

2. Promoting Tree-Planting Initiatives (Mid-term):

The government should establish tree-planting targets for each city and county based on the total amount of greenhouse gas emissions produced by motor vehicles. This policy aims to improve urban greenery and enhance air quality. By first estimating the total emissions from vehicles in each region and then calculating the number of trees required according to their carbon absorption capacity, the government can offset a portion of these emissions. Since urban areas have higher vehicle density and experience more severe air pollution, they should be given priority when implementing this policy and receive higher tree-planting targets. In contrast, rural areas generally have lower vehicle ownership and produce fewer emissions, so the policy can be implemented more flexibly according to local conditions. Trees should be planted in suitable locations such as roadsides, parks, school campuses, and vacant

land. In addition to absorbing carbon dioxide and certain air pollutants, urban trees can also help reduce heat accumulation and improve residents' living environments.

To ensure the long-term effectiveness of this initiative, each city and county government should be responsible for establishing a tree maintenance and monitoring system. Local authorities should regularly inspect planted trees and provide necessary maintenance, including watering, pruning, soil improvement, pest and disease control, and replacing trees that fail to survive. In addition, governments can use digital monitoring systems to record tree locations, growth conditions, and maintenance schedules, allowing resources to be allocated more efficiently.

Rather than focusing solely on the number of trees planted, equal attention should be given to their long-term survival and ecological benefits. The government should also cooperate with businesses, schools, and local communities through tree adoption programs, encouraging citizens to participate in tree care and environmental protection. Through continuous maintenance, public participation, and regular evaluation, this policy can maximize the contribution of urban forests to improving air quality and reducing the environmental impacts of transportation emissions.

3. Expand and Improve Public Transportation (Long-term):

Although expanding MRT systems can significantly reduce greenhouse gas and PM2.5 emissions by encouraging people to shift from private vehicles to public transportation, we recognize that large-scale metro construction faces challenges such as high costs, complex urban planning, and differences in population density between urban and rural areas.

Therefore, the government should adopt a comprehensive transportation strategy that considers the needs of different regions.

In major metropolitan areas such as Taichung and Kaohsiung, governments should continue expanding MRT networks by developing new routes, increasing station accessibility, and improving connections between different transportation systems. The successful experiences of existing MRT systems in Taipei, Kaohsiung, and Taichung demonstrate how efficient public transportation can reduce dependence on private vehicles and improve urban mobility.

For suburban and rural areas where MRT systems may not be economically feasible due to lower population density and higher construction costs, governments should strengthen alternative public transportation options. These improvements should include increasing bus routes, expanding bus stop coverage, improving service frequency, and promoting electric buses to reduce transportation-related emissions. In addition, integrated transportation systems, such as shuttle buses connecting residential areas to major transit stations, can provide more convenient alternatives to private cars.

To ensure long-term effectiveness, transportation planning should involve cooperation among local governments, transportation agencies, and environmental authorities. By developing accessible, efficient, and low-emission public transportation networks, Taiwan can reduce reliance on private vehicles, decrease PM2.5 emissions from transportation, ease traffic congestion, and improve overall urban air quality.

Energy Transition & Low-Carbon Power Systems

Renewable energy	According to the United Nations (UN) and the International Energy Agency (IEA), renewable energy is defined as energy obtained from naturally replenishing resources. Major sources of renewable energy include solar, wind, hydropower, geothermal, and biomass energy.
Energy transition	The transition from traditional fossil fuel-based energy to renewable energy sources is intended to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, increase the use of clean energy, and support sustainable development.
Taiwan Net-Zero plan	Taiwan Net-Zero Plan is an initiative aimed at reducing greenhouse gas emissions to as close to zero as possible, while ensuring that any remaining emissions can be reabsorbed by the atmosphere, oceans, and forests.

Preamble

Under Taiwan's 2050 Net-Zero Emissions Roadmap, the industrial sector faces an urgent need to transition from fossil fuels to renewable energy. The expansion of renewable energy sources, including solar energy, offshore wind power, hydropower, geothermal energy, and biomass energy, has helped reduce greenhouse gas emissions while enhancing Taiwan's industrial competitiveness. However, many industries continue to rely heavily on fossil fuels, making the transformation of industrial energy systems a major challenge. Taiwan's net-zero roadmap demonstrates the government's commitment to reducing carbon emissions while supporting industrial transformation. Achieving the 2050 net-zero target will require balancing the needs of traditional industries with the development of modern, low-carbon industries. This report examines Taiwan's current policies, implementation strategies, and recommendations for accelerating the industrial energy transition.

Research and Current Action

Taichung City's 115th Year Net-Zero Green School Initiative

Taichung City will host the Net-Zero Green Campus Plan Writing Workshop and Achievement Sharing Meeting. Each elementary, junior high, and senior high school will send one to two student representatives to participate and present their school's achievements. The 2025 Net-Zero Green Campus Plan is an environmental sustainability initiative that promotes carbon reduction and sustainable development in schools. The program aims to help schools create practical and long-term strategies for achieving net-zero emissions while fostering environmental awareness among students and staff.

Professors, environmental experts, project team members, and participating schools from Taichung City take part in this initiative. Schools submit their sustainability projects, and experts evaluate their performance based on established net-zero and environmental criteria. Throughout the program, team members work closely with each selected school to assess its environmental conditions, identify areas for improvement, and develop a customized net-zero green campus plan. This includes providing professional guidance on energy conservation, waste reduction, carbon emission management, renewable energy use, and other sustainable practices. Professors and experts also review the schools' progress and conduct the evaluation process for selecting the Outstanding Schools of the 2026 Taichung City Net-Zero Green Campus Plan.

The expected outcomes are the development of effective and practical net-zero action plans tailored to each school's needs, improved environmental management and sustainability practices, increased awareness of climate change among school communities, and the recognition of schools that demonstrate outstanding achievements in implementing net-zero initiatives. These efforts also encourage the sharing of successful experiences, inspiring more schools to adopt sustainable practices and contribute to Taiwan's net-zero goals.

2030 Passenger Car Electrification Promotion Plan - Ministry of Transportation

In March 2022, Taiwan announced the "Taiwan 2050 Net Zero Emissions Pathway and Strategy," and one of the key strategies is "electrification and decarbonization of vehicles," with a priority focus on commercially mature passenger vehicles. In the past, electric buses were limited by factors such as product performance, high prices, charging infrastructure, maintenance systems, and the lack of localization of key technologies and components. As a result, bus operators weren't very willing to replace their fleets, and the numbers grew slowly.

Policy Recommendation

The Taichung City Government could invite a broader range of students to participate in environmental sustainability projects, rather than limiting involvement to just one or two representatives per school. Currently, only a handful of schools are equipped with solar panels; true "green campuses" can only be achieved if the government provides schools with regular annual funding to install energy-saving equipment, solar panels, recycling systems, and green spaces. Schools could also invite relevant professors or experts to give talks, making "net-zero emissions" a familiar concept to students and encouraging them to explore the topic in greater depth. High schools and above can also work with the government to promote exhibitions or presentations, giving students more room to grow. Maybe the projects or products they create could be used in the future, showing the impact young people can have on social sustainability!

2 While electric buses are indeed more common on the road now, they are still a minority. Most policies state that replacing all buses and passenger transport with electric vehicles would not only reduce carbon emissions but also bring many benefits, but attention should be paid to implementation and improvement. The government could also solicit opinions from the public and bus riders to make changes more suitable for everyone. Training more personnel

skilled in electric vehicle maintenance would also be beneficial, ensuring assistance is available when electric buses require repairs. One point not mentioned in the policy is that if all buses and passenger transport are eventually replaced with electric vehicles, charging or other refueling methods will inevitably be needed. Shouldn't public charging stations be built now? Data monitoring is also crucial; the quality and operational status of vehicles must be monitored in real time. The government could regularly schedule inspections of electric buses, such as every six months or every few months. To achieve the 2030 target, now is the time to begin construction, and hopefully, one day we will see the government's efforts in this policy reflected in the news.

Sustainable Urban Mobility Systems

Sustainable Urban Mobility	Sustainable Urban Mobility refers to transportation that is efficient, safe, accessible, and environmentally friendly. Its goal is to reduce traffic congestion, air pollution, and carbon emissions while improving people's quality of life.
Public Transportation	A transportation system that is available for everyone to use, including buses, MRT systems, and trains. It helps reduce the use of private vehicles, lowering greenhouse gas emissions and air pollution.
Low-carbon Transportation	Low-carbon Transportation refers to transportation methods that produce fewer carbon emissions, such as electric vehicles, bicycles, and walking. These options help reduce greenhouse gas emissions and support sustainable development.
Mobility Planning	Mobility Planning means designing transportation strategies and policies to improve accessibility, efficiency, safety, sustainability, and economic activity in cities. It helps governments create transportation systems that better meet the needs of both residents and businesses.
Smart Mobility	Smart Mobility uses technology, such as real-time traffic information and intelligent transportation systems, to link various transport modes, such as buses, MRT systems, bike-sharing services, and ride-sharing services, allowing people to easily transfer between different modes of transportation, making transportation more efficient, convenient, and safer.

Preamble

Sustainable urban mobility is an important priority in Taiwan because the transportation sector has a direct impact on both the environment and public health. Taiwan has introduced the TPASS, a monthly public transportation pass that offers unlimited travel on MRT systems, buses, railways, and other public transit services in many cities to encourage people to use public transportation. However, despite this policy and Taiwan's well-developed MRT, bus, and YouBike systems, many people still rely on private scooters and cars because they are more convenient and flexible. Therefore, improving existing public transportation policies and encouraging more people to use sustainable transport can reduce emissions, improve air quality, and build healthier, more sustainable communities.

Research and Current Action

1 2030 Bus Electrification Promotion Plan

1. Challenges

Electric buses were previously slow to gain widespread adoption due to unstable performance, high purchase costs, limited charging infrastructure, insufficient maintenance systems, and a lack of locally produced key components. As a result, these challenges reduced the willingness of bus operators to replace conventional diesel buses. Although a demonstration project that operated electric buses across Taiwan from 2020 to 2022 to test and evaluate vehicle performance, charging needs, and maintenance requirements was carried out, approximately 9,400 diesel buses still remained in service and required replacement after three years.

2. Strategies

To speed up the creation of a sustainable urban mobility system, the Ministry of Transportation and Communications and the Ministry of Environment jointly launched the "2030 Bus Electrification Promotion Plan" with a budget of NT\$64.3 billion. Furthermore, this plan supports low-carbon transportation by reducing purchase costs and providing maintenance and operational support. Four key strategies are being implemented. The first focuses on improving service performance through certification and smart mobility monitoring. The second strengthens incentives via demonstration projects and subsidy adjustments. The third enhances charging infrastructure with mobility planning for future needs. The fourth aims to construct an international industrial value chain by localizing key components and developing maintenance systems.

3. Expected Benefits

Total quantifiable benefits are estimated at NT\$227.1 billion. These include NT\$155.8 billion in industrial added value, as demand for electric buses boosts local supply chains and contributes to sustainable urban mobility; NT\$53.06 billion from air pollution reduction, by cutting harmful PM2.5 emissions; NT\$13.79 billion from fuel savings, as diesel is replaced by electricity; NT\$2.43 billion from accident cost reductions through smart safety technologies; and NT\$2.06 billion from CO₂ savings, by replacing diesel buses with electric ones.

4. Affected Groups

The policy directly affects urban bus operators, who receive subsidies and operational support; the electric bus and parts industry, which benefits from supply chain development; and the general public, who enjoy cleaner air and better public transportation services.

5. Future Outlook

Full bus electrification will deliver higher-quality, low-carbon public transport, help local technologies enter global supply chains, and strengthen the maintenance workforce, thereby creating new industry opportunities. This transition represents a critical step toward achieving sustainable urban mobility in Taiwan.

2 Energy-Saving Measures and Low-Carbon Practices of Taipei MRT

1. Challenges

Taipei MRT faces three major environmental challenges sustainable urban mobility. First, climate change threatens system stability, with a lightning strike disrupting the Wenhua Line in August 2023. Second, over 90% of its electricity comes from Taiwan Power Company, so its carbon reduction progress depends on national grid improvements. The MRT uses standard grid electricity and has no plans for Renewable Energy Certificates, RECs, or green power agreements. Although it generates solar energy at six depots, over 99% of that power is sold back to Taipower instead of being used to run trains. As a result, while the MRT is a "green"

mode of transport, its operations still run on "gray" electricity, and its decarbonization success depends on the national grid's emission factor. Third, noise and vibration affect nearby residents, with mitigation costs reaching NT\$2.78 million in 2023.

2. Strategies

In May 2023, a board-level Sustainability Committee was established to make sustainability and ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) a key part of the company's decision-making process. ESG stands for Environmental, Social, and Governance, a framework that helps organizations assess their sustainability performance. Under the vision "Go Greener, SHINE Brighter!" The "MRT Smart Cloud" was launched and AI-controlled air conditioning was piloted at Zhongshan Station, using data-driven analysis to enhance energy efficiency. In addition, solar power systems were installed at six depots, waste conductor rails were upcycled into gifts, and a new EURO V track inspection vehicle was adopted to reduce emissions and noise.

3. Environmental Performance Data

Driven by TPASS monthly pass, a combined regional fare program launched in July 2023 that offers unlimited travel on MRT, buses, and railways within the Taipei-Keelung-New Taipei-Taoyuan area for NT\$1,200 per month, ridership exceeded 710 million trips in 2023, a 20.93% increase, while per-passenger-kilometer electricity use dropped 16% to 0.124 kilowatt-hour, the best efficiency on record. Total carbon reduction reached 11,439 metric tons of carbon dioxide equivalent. Water use dropped 5.04%, and paper use fell 52.15%. System reliability hit a record 19.116 million car-kilometers, a key factor in attracting passengers to switch from private vehicles to public transportation.

4. Affected Groups

Public transportation users benefit from the Taipei Metro Go app. Residents benefit from noise monitoring and sound barriers. 208 students in remote schools also gain from volunteer support.

5. Future Outlook

Future priorities include strengthening lightning protection, adding dual-circuit power supplies, and installing electric bus charging stations at Beitou Depot. The "ACT NOW" campaign continues to encourage citizens to shift from private vehicles to the MRT, making the system a core driver of Taipei's sustainable urban mobility and 2050 net-zero goal.

3 Taoyuan X SDGs - Green Transport Strategy

1. Challenges

Taoyuan faces two major challenges. The city has 2.2 million private vehicles and nearly 3 million daily commuters, making carbon reduction a critical issue for sustainable urban mobility. As Taiwan's gateway and a major industrial hub with the fastest population growth among six major cities, rising population and industrial activity continue to increase vehicle registrations and carbon emissions.

2. Strategies

The city promotes diverse low-carbon transportation options, including buses, trains, MRT, YouBike, GoShare, and walking. The TPASS monthly pass integrates ticketing across Taipei, Keelung, New Taipei, and Taoyuan and has become the most popular public transportation pass in Taiwan. In addition, a smart mobility traffic control center uses signal optimization and dynamic control to improve traffic flow and reduce emissions. All traffic signals are equipped

with wireless modules for remote adjustment, while roadside detection devices and China Central Television cameras enable real-time traffic monitoring.

3. Results and Key Data

Taoyuan ranks first among six major cities in sustainable urban mobility performance, with travel time per 10 kilometers at 15 minutes, the lowest, and peak-hour speed at 30 km/h, the highest. MRT ridership grew from 70,000 to over 100,000 daily after the TPASS launch, and the private vehicle shift rate reached 11.93%, the highest in the region.

4. Affected Groups

Commuters benefit directly from the TPASS monthly pass through lower transportation costs; all residents benefit from improved road efficiency, reduced air pollution, expanded EV charging stations, and new sidewalks and bike lanes as part of long-term mobility planning.

5. Future Outlook

Plans include expanding the MRT network, increasing the share of electric vehicle charging piles in public parking lots from 2% to 4%, and designing new redevelopment areas with grid-pattern roads, spacious sidewalks, and bike lanes to encourage walking, all of which contribute to sustainable urban mobility. The city will also develop connected vehicle technologies to further reduce transport-related environmental burdens.

Policy Recommendation

1 Government Recommendation A

The Ministry of Transportation and Communications (MOTC) should work with city and county Transportation Bureaus to expand Taichung City's free 10-km bus policy to other cities and counties in Taiwan. Transportation Bureaus can partner with local bus operators to provide free bus rides for residents and students through registered Citizen Cards or Student IDs. The fare system would automatically calculate the travel distance and waive the fare for trips within 10 kilometers.

- How it addresses the issue

- (1) Makes public transportation more affordable.
- (2) Encourages people to choose buses instead of scooters and private cars.
- (3) Reduces traffic congestion, air pollution, and carbon emissions.
- (4) Promotes equal access to public transportation across Taiwan.

1. Government Recommendation B

Local governments should work with schools and MRT operators to introduce a Student Free MRT Zone Program. Students could receive free MRT rides within 3–5 stations of their school after registering their National Health Insurance (NHI) card and Student ID. The student discount would be linked to their transit card.

- How it addresses the issue

- (1) Encourages students to use public transportation instead of private vehicles.
- (2) Reduces traffic congestion around schools.
- (3) Supports safer and more sustainable school commuting.
- (4) Helps students develop lifelong public transportation habits.

2. Government Recommendation C

City and county governments should expand YouBike discount programs and improve access to bike-sharing services across more neighborhoods. Residents could use their Citizen Card or transportation card to receive discounted or free YouBike rides for the first 30 minutes; this is references from the major cities in Taiwan as previous successful precursors.

- How it addresses the issue

- (1) Encourages more people to choose bicycles for short trips.
- (2) Reduces the use of scooters and private cars.
- (3) Helps reduce traffic congestion and air pollution.
- (4) Promotes healthier and more environmentally friendly travel.

This recommendation is also realistic because many cities in Taiwan already have YouBike systems. Local governments only need to expand existing discount programs and make them available in more areas, rather than creating a completely new system.

Food Systems and Climate-Resilient Agriculture

Food transportation	The process of moving food from where it is produced, such as farms or fishing areas, to places where it is processed, stored, sold, or consumed. This strategy connects food-producers with consumers and plays an important role in the food supply system.
Food security	Ensuring that all people have consistent access to sufficient, safe, and nutritious food through physical, economic, and social means. Food security allows individuals to meet their dietary needs and maintain a healthy lifestyle.
Climate Adaptation	Refers to the process of adjusting to the current and expected climate changes impacts to reduce harm, manage risks, and take advantage of possible opportunities.

Preamble

- This statement focuses on how our local food systems must adapt to climate change through resilient agriculture. Rising temperatures and extreme weather are already threatening local crop production and food supply chains. By analyzing these specific challenges in our area, this report connects environmental theory with real-world situations. Ultimately, this introduction prepares readers for a deeper look into local policies and the practical solutions needed to secure our food supply.

Research and Current Action

Incident/Event/Policy/Program # 1

- Previous Policies:
- In 2011, New Taipei City launched the "Safe Vegetables Daily" initiative, which was later upgraded in 2013 to the "Weekly Organic Vegetable School Lunch" program for elementary and junior high schools.
- • The Turning Point: Initially, the policy focused strictly on student health. However, following the adoption of the UN SDGs, the city government recognized that food waste was a massive environmental loophole. To address this, the city shifted its perspective from a mere "school welfare program" to a "full-lifecycle circular economy for food," seamlessly connecting school contract farming with the newly established New Taipei City Food Sharing Network.
- Action & Target Audience
- Current Actions:
- Planned Production (Source Stabilization): The city government signs contract farming agreements with organic farmers across Taiwan, securing a stable supply of over 39 tons of organic vegetables per week for school lunches, thereby stabilizing the sustainable agriculture market.
- Food Rescue & Redistribution (End-of-Pipe Waste Reduction):
- The "Food Sharing Network" connects wholesale fruit and vegetable markets, hypermarkets, and NGOs to rescue "ugly produce" or surplus food before it becomes waste. This food is redistributed to community kitchens for the elderly and vulnerable groups.
- Target Audience
- • Organic Farmers: Gain guaranteed purchase prices and stable income, incentivizing green farming practices.
- • Over 300,000 Teachers and Students: Access healthy, low-carbon, locally sourced organic meals.
- • Vulnerable Communities & Social Welfare NGOs: Receive nutritious, free meals through rescued food resources.
- Positive Highlights & Successes
- A Win-Win Eco-system: By utilizing the power of public procurement (SDG 12)
- The local government bolsters the domestic organic agriculture supply chain while simultaneously improving student nutrition (SDG 2).
- Effective Public-Private Partnerships (PPP): The city successfully integrated retail chains, charity kitchens, farmers' associations, and logistics providers to intercept food surplus and put it to use before it rots in landfills and generates greenhouse gases.
- Gaps & What Needs to be Addressed
- Despite its success, evaluating the program against global benchmarks reveals several areas that require improvement:
- • Lack of Precise Data Tracking (Data Disconnect): Current reports focus heavily on input metrics (e.g., "how many tons of organic vegetables were supplied" or "how many items were rescued"). However, there is a lack of rigorous tracking regarding the actual Food Waste Index. Precise digital tracking of how much food is thrown away at the school or household level is still missing.
- High Cold-Chain & Logistics Costs: Surplus food and "ugly" produce have a very short shelf life. The current food rescue network relies heavily on volunteers, lacking a

systematic, smart cold-chain logistics infrastructure. This often leads to secondary food spoilage during transportation. • Insufficient Behavioral Change at the Household Level: While public procurement (schools and government agencies) has improved, global data shows that up to 60% of food waste occurs within households. Transforming school-taught food-saving values into actual consumer behavior at home remains a major hurdle.
• Incident/Event/Policy/Program # 2 • 2024, extreme weather events—including heatwaves, droughts, and torrential rains—led to significant crop yield losses in regions such as France, Brazil, the United States, and Africa. Rising food prices have prompted the United Nations to once again call on nations to build more resilient food systems.
• Incident/Event/Policy/Program # 3 • While the U.S. has plenty of climate adaptation plans, actual implementation is stalled by limited funding, institutional barriers, and data gaps. Most current actions are just small tweaks rather than the major transformations needed. To move forward, efforts must focus on breaking down policy barriers, engaging stakeholders, and creating clear metrics to measure success.

Policy Recommendation
• Implement "Smart Weighing Scales" and Waste Reduction Rebates in Schools • The Demand: The Bureau of Education should update school lunch procurement contracts to install IoT-enabled smart weighing scales in all public school kitchens to accurately track daily food waste data. (explain what IoT-enabled smart weighing scales is here and what it can do SPECIFICALLY to the schools and students.) • Actionability: The local government holds direct administrative authority over public schools. By introducing a "Waste Reduction Rebate," schools that drop below their food waste baselines will receive a portion of the saved waste-management fees back into their school activities or club funds, creating a powerful financial incentive. Launch a "Green Restaurant & Household Rewards" Municipal Incentive Program Local governments should create incentive programs that encourage restaurants, households, and communities to reduce food waste. Restaurants that cooperate with food-sharing organizations and reduce unnecessary food disposal could receive benefits such as reduced waste-management fees or public recognition. Households that participate in composting programs or food waste reduction activities could earn rewards (need more detail of how this works). •• Actionability: • For Businesses: Restaurants that partner with the Food Sharing Network to reduce ingredient waste will receive discounts on municipal waste-disposal fees or free marketing exposure on the city's public transit advertising networks. • For Households: Citizens who participate in community composting or household waste-reduction challenges can earn digital points through the city's resident app, which can be redeemed for public transit rides or local public facility entry fees.

- Countries should develop climate-resilient agriculture, improve water resource management, and establish stable food supply chains;

In order to make climate planning more than just a slogan, local governments must use the existing administrative power to turn adjustment work into mandatory regulations and budget review, and let young people really participate in decision-making. The following are three practical and feasible policy suggestions:

1. Give Youth and Communities "Policy Review Power"

Most public hearings are just for show. Local governments need a formal system that lets the youth and residents who are actually affected by climate change join the decision-making process.

- Actionable Strategy: Establish a permanent Youth and Community Climate Advisory Council.
- Local Enforcement: Before the city approves major public projects (like building new roads or drainage systems), the project must be reviewed by this council for a "Letter of Support or Objection." If the council objects, the project must go back to the City Council for a public debate and re-vote.

2. Screen All Major Public Spending with a "Climate Lens"

Cities often complain about having no money for climate action, but the solution is to weave climate safety into the money they are already spending.

- Actionable Strategy: Implement a "Climate Lens" budget review policy.
- Local Enforcement: Whether the Transportation Department is buying buses or the Public Works Department is repairing a bridge, any budget request over a certain amount must prove it can withstand future extreme weather (like severe floods or heatwaves). If it fails this test, the Budget Office will freeze the funds.

3. Create Neighborhood "Climate Risk Maps"

National climate data is often too broad. Local governments need precise information to protect their citizens on the ground.

- Actionable Strategy: Partner with local universities to study climate risks in specific neighborhoods and launch an open-access "Climate Vulnerability Dashboard."
- Local Enforcement: Managed by the city's IT or Research Department, this online map will clearly pinpoint areas facing severe heat islands or urban flooding. The city must then prioritize its funding and disaster-relief resources for the "red zones" on the map.

Biodiversity Protection and Ecosystem Conservation

Marine Pollution	Marine pollution is the introduction of harmful substances, such as plastic waste, chemicals, and other pollutants, into oceans and marine environments. Plastic pollution is a major concern because it can persist for long periods before it breaks down into microplastics and gets consumed by marine organisms.
Invasive Species	An invasive species is a plant, animal, or other organism that is brought to a new environment where it is not naturally found and spreads quickly. Because it often has few natural predators in its new habitat, it can outcompete native species for food, space, and other resources. These non-native species can spread in a new environment and cause harm to local ecosystems .
Habitat fragmentation	Habitat fragmentation is the process of breaking a large habitat into smaller, separated pieces, often because of roads, cities, or agriculture. These isolated habitat patches make it more difficult for wildlife to find food, reproduce, and access safe living areas. As a result, species populations may decline, biodiversity can decrease, and ecosystems may become less stable.

Preamble

Biodiversity protection and ecosystem conservation are essential to maintaining healthy environments and sustainable communities. This issue is especially significant in Taiwan, where a remarkable variety of species and ecosystems exist within a small geographic area. However, habitat loss, urban development, climate change, and invasive species continue to threaten this unique natural heritage. As these challenges grow, the following theme aims to present the current challenges and solutions in protecting wildlife: a sustainable future for both people and nature.

Research and Current Action

RHINOSHIELD company

- Founded in 2012, RHINOSHIELD is a Taiwanese electronics accessories company that shifted toward heavy environmental awareness in the late 2010s.
- After cutting raw material waste by 50% with fully recyclable "Mono-Material" cases in 2017, they launched the (CircularNext) series in 2024, featuring 100% recycled materials and an industry-first QR code for consumers to track the product's recycling history.
- RHINOSHIELD developed a CircularBlue ocean cleanup system, which uses AI scanning drones, solar-powered robots, and floating platforms to detect and collect ocean plastic waste.
- It targets young consumers and phone case users, who are drawn to sustainable, tech-driven products and may become more aware of ocean conservation through everyday items.
- A major limitation is the high cost of developing and operating marine robots and AI systems, which makes large-scale expansion difficult without external support. Stronger government funding, policy support, and partnerships are needed to expand the number of deployed robots and maximize environmental impact.
- The project successfully combines technology and sustainability, using AI and renewable solar energy to actively remove ocean waste in an innovative way. It also creates a circular economy model, where ocean plastic is collected and transformed into recyclable phone cases instead of becoming permanent waste.

Payment for Ecosystem Services (PES)

- Taiwan introduced the Payment for Ecosystem Services (PES) program in 2021 to protect the endangered Taiwan leopard cat by rewarding farmers for using wildlife-friendly farming practices.
- The program mainly affects rural farmers in Taichung, Miaoli, and Nantou, encouraging them to become active partners in wildlife conservation while providing an additional source of income.
- The program promotes cooperation among government agencies, local communities, businesses, and conservation groups, demonstrating that biodiversity protection is more effective when multiple stakeholders work together.
- According to a news article in December of 2025, since its implementation, the program has grown exponentially. It expanded from operating in 9 counties and 63 townships to covering 18 counties and 175 townships nationwide today.
- Furthermore, the program has successfully protected nearly 60% of protected species and observed the continued expansion of endangered species populations, including Taiwan leopard cats and Formosan black bears.
- However, the program also needs stronger infrastructure, including more wildlife corridors, road-crossing structures, and better land-use planning to reduce leopard cat roadkill caused by expanding transportation networks.

Taiwan Marine Conservation Act

- Passed in July 2024, the Marine Conservation Act is Taiwan's first comprehensive law designed specifically to protect ocean ecosystems. Instead of relying on scattered

environmental rules, this law is built around a clear foundation: “Five Powers” (Government legal authority), “Three Guarantees” (Local resource user protection), and “Two Pathways” (Citizen public lawsuits)

- To put the law into action, the government implemented a system for Marine Protected Areas. In strictly protected core zones, civilian boats are completely banned, and trespassers can face heavy fines. In surrounding buffer zones, sustainable activities like scientific research or eco-friendly aquaculture are allowed.
- The act focuses on major environmental challenges like habitat destruction, losing ocean biodiversity and damage to marine wildlife corridors. This directly affects fishermen, coastal communities, tourism operators, and marine industries, which may need to follow new conservation regulations within protected areas.
- Before this law was passed, Taiwan relied on a patchwork of outdated statutes from different ministries that often led to legal loopholes. The 2024 legislation is a major milestone because it gives Taiwan a way to actively restore damaged habitats and manage Marine Protected Areas effectively.

Policy Recommendation

1: Turn School Campuses into Micro Ecosystems

- Local education should partner with urban greening/agriculture governmental departments to provide funding and policy guidelines for public schools to transfer unused campus green spaces into habitats for native species. (Ex: Planting native plants, Constructing eco-ponds)
- Arrange seasonal ecological surveys in students’ curriculums to monitor native birds, amphibians, and insects, uploading data directly to local government biodiversity databases.
- Since city development can fragment natural habitats, with this policy, school campuses can become active shelters for threatened local species. In addition, this policy also teaches students the importance of biodiversity by utilizing student monitoring to help government tracking.

2: Establish Youth-Led Wildlife Conservation and Eco-Protection Road Programs

- Government should establish a long-term program that partners with schools to involve students in wildlife conservation and roadkill prevention, rather than limiting participation to a small number of researchers or environmental clubs
- Provide funding for schools to collaborate with science organizations such as roadkill observation groups, to organize lectures, field workshops that teach students about habitat fragmentation and local biodiversity.
- By combining environmental education and long-term government investment, this policy could reduce wildlife roadkills and allow students to contribute to local environment restoration

3: Replacing Plastic Straws with Pasta Straws

- 3. Substitute single-use plastic straws with thick, hollow pasta straws. These are entirely edible and harmless to animals, leaving zero toxic footprint even if they accidentally enter rivers or oceans.

Gender Equality and Social Inclusion in the Workplace

Workplace Discrimination	It is the unfair treatment of employees or job applicants based on characteristics such as gender, age, race, disability, or other personal factors. Workplace discrimination can limit equal opportunities and prevent individuals from reaching their full potential.
Equal Opportunity	Everyone has a fair chance to study, work, and develop their careers. Individuals should be evaluated based on their abilities, qualifications, and efforts rather than their personal background or characteristics.
Social Inclusion	The process of ensuring that everyone is respected, valued, and able to participate equally in society. Inclusive workplaces recognize diversity in an environment where people feel welcome and supported.
Gender Equality	The principle that people of all genders have equal rights, opportunities, and responsibilities in society and the workplace. This includes creating an inclusive environment where people of all gender identities: including non-binary individuals and other underrepresented groups, are respected and supported.

Preamble

Gender equality and social inclusion in the workplace are essential to building a fair and productive society. In Taiwan, although considerable progress has been made in promoting gender equality, challenges such as gender stereotypes, wage gaps, unequal promotion opportunities, and difficulties in balancing work and family responsibilities continue to affect many employees. These issues not only limit individual career development but also reduce workplace diversity and organizational performance.

Research and Current Action

MINISTRY OF LABOR : Gender Equality in Employment Act

The Act provides maternity leave, prenatal check-up and paternity leave, and unpaid parental leave to support employees and their families.

EXECUTIVE YUAN :

- Promotes women's participation in public decision-making and leadership.

<https://gec.ey.gov.tw/File/CD1AE794154F95FD?A=C>

1. Real Event: Taiwan's 2025 Gender Pay Gap Report.

- In 2025, Taiwan's Ministry of Labor reported that women earned 16.1% less than men on average.
- Women had to work 59 more days than men to earn the same annual salary.
- The report highlighted the motherhood penalty, meaning that many working mothers receive lower pay and fewer promotion opportunities after having children.
- The findings attracted public attention and renewed discussions about gender equality in the workplace.

2. Previous Policy

- Taiwan introduced the Gender Equality in Employment Act to reduce gender discrimination at work.
- It helps make sure that men and women receive equal pay for the same work and provides maternity leave and parental leave.
- The goal of this law is to give everyone a fair chance in the workplace.
- Even though this law has improved workplace equality, the gender pay gap still has not completely disappeared.

3. Current Action and Turning Point

- The government is discussing greater salary transparency to reduce gender pay inequality.
- The 2025 wage report became an important turning point because the gender pay gap increased instead of decreasing.
- A report by the Control Yuan found that women aged 40–49 with children under three earned about NT\$12,000 less per month, showing the impact of the motherhood penalty.
- Government agencies, such as the Ministry of Labor, alongside labor rights organizations, believe that salary transparency and better childcare support can help reduce wage inequality.

4. Audience

- Primary Caregivers and Workers of all genders are affected by the career interruptions associated with childcare responsibilities.
- Non-binary individuals and single parents often face distinct institutional biases regarding wage fairness and workplace support.
- Employers are encouraged to provide fair pay and equal promotion opportunities.

5. Missing Issues

- Salary information is still not transparent enough in many companies. Future measures should balance salary transparency with employee privacy to promote fairness without compromising personal data.
- Women often do not know whether they are being paid fairly because salary information is not publicly available.
- More affordable childcare services and flexible working arrangements are needed.
- Equal pay laws should be enforced more effectively.

6. Positive Actions

- Taiwan has implemented the Gender Equality in Employment Act to protect employees from gender discrimination and ensure workplace rights.
- Public awareness of the gender pay gap has been significantly heightened through the annual promotion of "Equal Pay Day" by the Ministry of Labor, alongside extensive media coverage surrounding the societal impacts of the motherhood penalty.

- Continued policy improvements can help create a fairer and more inclusive workplace.

Incident/Event/Policy/Program # 3

1. Real Program: Taiwan's Women Energy Inspector Workshop

- We found a real local project in Taiwan called the "Women Energy Inspector Workshop," which was started by Dr. Chen Hui-ping and the Mom Climate Action Alliance.
- She created this program because Taiwan has a big "Green Gender Gap" problem, meaning that women only make up one-third of the workers in green tech companies, so male workers get almost all the good jobs and economic benefits.

2. Previous Policy

- In the past, the government's environmental policies only cared about technical goals like reducing carbon emissions, so most green training programs did not consider the actual needs of female workers.
- Traditional engineering and technology jobs in Taiwan are also almost all for male workers, which makes it very difficult for stay-at-home mothers or women with limited employment opportunities to enter this field and get high-paying green jobs.

3. Current Action and Turning Point

- This workshop teaches stay-at-home mothers, new immigrants, and women from disadvantaged backgrounds practical skills about home electricity checks and energy saving so they can help many families save money.
- This action is a great turning point because it changes their lives by letting them learn these useful skills, and it also successfully shows everyone that female workers can do green tech just as well as men.

4. Audience

- Stay-at-home mothers and women with limited employment opportunities can benefit from access to flexible and stable job opportunities. Families can also reduce household expenses by saving on electricity costs through the adoption of green technologies. In addition, green technology companies can expand their workforce by creating more employment opportunities for women. The program infused the theme of gender equality into climate action.
- Lower-mid income families living in Taiwan also benefit because they can save a lot of money on their electricity bills through these home energy checks.

5. Missing Issues

- But this program is currently run by a small non-government group, so they do not have enough funding or a big team to help women living in rural areas or other cities.
- The government still does not have a national policy to provide financial support to this kind of training, and we still need more promotion so more companies become willing to hire these female energy inspectors.

6. Positive Actions

- The workshop creates real social inclusion because it helps people who are usually forgotten, and it shows a good way to save the environment and help people facing gender inequality at the same time.

- Public awareness of the green gender gap has increased because this program is very successful, and if the government can support this model, we can expand it to more places in Taiwan.

Policy Recommendation

1The Ministry of Labor should do more to make sure companies really follow the Gender Equality in Employment Act. For example, the government can make a rule that companies must hire a certain percentage of women, people with disabilities, and non-binary people. This is important because it matches the core meaning of gender equality, which means every person should have the same rights and opportunities at work. Also, the government should check companies without telling them first to make sure pay is fair, and they should build safe, secret ways for workers to report discrimination without worrying about losing their jobs.

2Local governments should collaborate with professional non-government organizations and labor experts to provide mandatory gender equality and diversity training every semester for schools, universities, and businesses. This training should focus on solving issues like the green gender gap—which refers to the underrepresentation and wage disparity of women in green transition sectors—and sustainable technology jobs and unequal career promotion, while teaching students and employees about common stereotypes, such as the idea that tech or engineering jobs are only for male workers. By doing this regularly, we can successfully reduce unfair treatment, promote respectful workplaces, and better prepare young people with a clear understanding of workplace rights before they enter the workforce.

The government should expand childcare support for working families by increasing childcare subsidies and improving access to affordable childcare services. It should also encourage employers to offer flexible working hours and remote work options. These family-friendly policies can help employees balance their work and family responsibilities, increase women's participation in the workforce, and promote gender equality in the workplace.

Climate Risk & Disaster Resilience

shelter	A safe place where people can stay during emergencies or natural disasters. Shelters provide basic needs such as food, water, and a place to rest
natural disasters	Natural disasters are dangerous events caused by nature, such as earthquakes, typhoons, floods, and wildfires. They can damage homes, roads, and buildings, and may cause injuries or loss of life.
man-made disasters	Man made disasters are disasters caused by human activities or mistakes. Examples include fires, chemical spills, oil spills, and industrial accidents. They can harm people, property, and the environment
recovery	Recovery is the process of rebuilding and returning to normal after a disaster. It includes repairing homes, restoring services, and helping people recover physically and emotionally

Preamble

Taiwan is frequently affected by natural hazards such as earthquakes, typhoons, and extreme rainfall. These climate-related risks can damage housing, infrastructure, and public services in posing challenges for communities in dailies. Disaster resilience becomes a critical topic for Taiwan because it educates communities to better prepare for hazards, emergencies, and recover from disasters.

Research and Current Action

Event 1- 0403 Hualian earthquake

- Date: April 3, 2024 at 7:58 a.m.
Magnitude: 7.2
Epicenter: Hualian
- Main Findings: NT\$28.5 billion was used for rebuilding homes, roads, and public facilities.that were damaged by the earthquake. In addition, the Taiwan Railways North-Link Line, Taiwan High Speed Rail, and all metro systems were temporarily suspended. The Central Cross-Island Highway, the Suhua Highway, and the Suhua Highway Improvement Project route were also temporarily closed due to the earthquake. Also, the earthquake changed the natural landscape. Some mountain areas in Hualien County had landslides, which affected local roads. A small part of Guishan Island, located off the coast of Yilan County, also collapsed.

- Significance: Helps communities recover faster after the earthquake and raises government awareness of the importance of earthquake-resistant building, and prompts the central government to improve the national emergency alert system so that people can receive timely warnings during major disasters.

- E

Policy 1 – Disaster Prevention and Protection Act Amendment

- On May 7, 2019, the Legislative Yuan passed the Disaster Prevention and Protection Act Amendment. The policy aims to prevent the spread of false disaster information and improve disaster management in Taiwan. It targets false disaster reports, fake rescue or evacuation information, and other misinformation that may cause public panic or delay rescue operations. People who deliberately spread false information may face legal penalties.
- This policy affects all citizens, especially social media users, media platforms, and emergency response agencies. It is mainly enforced by the Ministry of the Interior, together with the police and other disaster management authorities. However, more public education on identifying misinformation and fact-checking is still needed to improve media literacy. Overall, this policy helps protect public safety, reduce panic, and improve disaster response.

Policy Recommendation

1. Strengthen Disaster Prevention

The city and county governments should strengthen natural disaster prevention measures. The Water Resources Bureau, Water Affairs Bureau, or Hydraulic Engineering Office is responsible for cleaning and maintaining drainage systems and flood prevention facilities. Before the rainy season, these departments should inspect facilities to ensure proper operation. The central government of the all Taiwan respected cities must undergoes a mandate review of local governments' maintenance work at least twice a year, especially between April and May before the plum rain season and between June and July before the typhoon season. If problems are found, local governments should be required to make improvements within a specified timeframe. During heatwaves, the Central Weather Administration and city and county governments should spread out heat warnings through cell broadcast messages. An ideal method includes television, news websites, and social media platforms to spread safety information. Citizens should be reminded to take protective measures such as sun protection and hydration. Water stations and shaded areas should be provided to reduce heatstroke risks.

2. Improve Disaster Response Capacity

City and county governments should provide funding and resources to establish local emergency teams in rural areas, such as Heping District in Taichung and other remote mountainous and coastal communities. The funding can be used for emergency equipment, communication tools, transportation, and basic training support. Local fire departments should provide training and coordinate these teams to improve rescue efficiency and reduce response time during disasters. In addition, city and county governments should cooperate with

neighboring cities by establishing a cross-regional support system. This system can include sharing rescue personnel, emergency equipment, and resources, as well as providing support when a serious disaster occurs. The central government and local governments should provide emergency survival kits for situations such as water and power outages. For elderly people living alone, local governments should establish community support networks by assigning volunteers or designated helpers to check their safety and provide assistance during disasters.

3. Strengthen Public Education on Extreme Weather

Public education on extreme weather should be strengthened. The Ministry of Education and local governments should include climate and disaster education in schools and provide educational programs through workshops, online platforms, and public campaigns. Workshops should include interactive activities, such as disaster response drills, emergency equipment practice, and demonstrations by firefighters or disaster prevention professionals. Online platforms should provide videos, emergency guidelines, and interactive learning materials to help people understand how to respond to extreme weather. Public campaigns should cooperate with television, news websites, and social media platforms to share disaster prevention information and teach people how to take simple daily actions to reduce the impact of climate change and slow down global warming.

Education should be adjusted for different age groups, with children learning basic disaster awareness through school education and drills, while adults focus on emergency response and climate actions in daily life. Elderly people should learn evacuation methods and how to seek help during disasters. Schools and communities should conduct disaster preparedness training at least once a year to improve public readiness.